

# geha-coverage-policy-pemetrexed.pdf

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### Pemetrexed: Alimta, Pemfexy, Pemrydi RTU

Effective Date: 12/5/2022

Revision Date(s): 12/5/2022; 11/7/2023; 12/29/2023; 5/23/24; 8/5/2024; 9/24/2024; 11/14/2024; 1/1/2025;  
07/01/2025; 10/1/2025

Review Date: 10/1/2025

Policy type: Medical Necessity

Line of Business: All GEHA Commercial Medical Plans

Authorizations are issued for 6 (six) months, unless the ordering physician requests a different timespan or the patients' unique circumstance, or condition supports the medical necessity for a different authorization timeframe. Reauthorization requests are reviewed for efficacy, safety and tolerability.

| Preference     | Requires Prior Auth | Drug Name                           | Code  |                                                                                  |
|----------------|---------------------|-------------------------------------|-------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ---            | ---                 | ---                                 | ---   | ---                                                                              |
| PREFERRED      | Yes                 | Pemetrexed (Axtle)                  | J9292 | Injection, pemetrexed dipotassium, 10 mg                                         |
| Non- Preferred | Yes                 | Pemetrexed (Hospira)                | J9294 | Injection, pemetrexed (hospira) not therapeutically equivalent to J9305, 10 mg   |
| PREFERRED      | Yes                 | Pemetrexed (Accord)                 | J9296 | Injection, pemetrexed (accord) not therapeutically equivalent to J9305, 10 mg    |
| Non- Preferred | Yes                 | Pemetrexed (Sandoz)                 | J9297 | Injection, pemetrexed (sandoz), not therapeutically equivalent to J9305, 10 mg   |
| Non- Preferred | Yes                 | Pemetrexed (Alimta)                 | J9305 | Injection, pemetrexed, not otherwise specified, 10 mg                            |
| Non- Preferred | Yes                 | Pemetrexed (Teva)                   | J9314 | Injection, pemetrexed (teva) not therapeutically equivalent to J9305, 10 mg      |
| PREFERRED      | Yes                 | Pemetrexed (Bluepoint)              | J9322 | Injection, pemetrexed (bluepoint) not therapeutically equivalent to J9305, 10 mg |
| Non- Preferred | Yes                 | Pemetrexed ditromethamine (Hospira) | J9323 | Injection, pemetrexed ditromethamine, 10 mg                                      |
| Non- Preferred | Yes                 | Pemfexy                             | J9304 | Injection, pemetrexed (pemfexy), 10 mg                                           |
| Non- Preferred | Yes                 | Pemrydi RTU                         | J9324 | Injection, pemetrexed (pemrydi rtu), 10 mg                                       |

Members must have documentation of a contraindication, failure, or intolerance to any of the preferred agents (or their 505(b)(2) equivalents) prior to approval of a non-preferred product, when clinically appropriate.

Preferred product requirements apply to new starts ONLY.

Step Therapy applies to all overlapping compendia supported indications/regimens

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### Universal Approval Criteria:

Unless otherwise noted, the review criteria used by OncoHealth to determine medical necessity for anticancer treatments and supportive agents include, but is not limited to:

National Comprehensive Cancer Network (NccN) - use consistent with NCCN recommendations carrying a Category 1 or 2A level of evidence; OR

United States Food and Drug Administration (FDA) labeling - new drugs or regimens (combinations of drugs) consistent with all components of the product labeling; OR

Indications not included in the official FDA labeling or recommended by NCCN (Category 1 or 2A level of evidence) may be considered if determined to be medically necessary per one or more of the following compendia:

O Clinical Pharmacology (Strong For); OR

O Wolters Kluwer Lexi-Drugs (Level A); OR

Other uses of drugs and biologics may be considered medically necessary if supported as safe and effective according to peer-reviewed articles from one of the following journals:

O American Journal of Medicine; Annals of Internal Medicine; Annals of Oncology; Annals of Surgical Oncology; Biology of Blood and Marrow Transplantation; Blood; Bone Marrow Transplantation; British Journal of Cancer; British Journal of Hematology; British Medical Journal; Cancer; Clinical Cancer Research; Drugs; European Journal of Cancer (formerly the European Journal of Cancer and Clinical Oncology); Gynecologic Oncology; International Journal of Radiation, Oncology, Biology, and Physics; The Journal of the American Medical Association; Journal of Clinical Oncology; Journal of the National Cancer Institute; Journal of the National Comprehensive Cancer Network (NccN); Journal of Urology; Lancet; Lancet Oncology; Leukemia; The New England Journal of Medicine; Radiation Oncology;

O Meeting abstracts and case reports are excluded from consideration;

Non-standard protocols may be approved based on unique clinical circumstances;

Dose and frequency should be consistent with United States Food and Drug Administration (FDA) labeling, National Comprehensive Cancer Network@ (NccN), or indication specific peer-reviewed literature;

In the instance that a request is made for drug(s) that was (were) previously tried (including in the same pharmacologic class or with the same mechanism of action) and such drug(s) was (were) discontinued due to a lack of efficacy the request may be subject to an off-label review for medical necessity unless supported by the NCCN or high quality literature (prospective phase 2 or 3 studies published as full manuscripts in a CMS-supported journal).

### Billing

| Drug Name            |       |                                                                                |
|----------------------|-------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Pemetrexed (Axtle)   | J9292 | Injection, pemetrexed dipotassium, 10 mg                                       |
| Pemetrexed (Hospira) | J9294 | Injection, pemetrexed (hospira) not therapeutically equivalent to J9305, 10 mg |
| Pemetrexed (Accord)  | J9296 | Injection, pemetrexed (accord) not therapeutically equivalent to J9305, 10 mg  |

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| Drug Name                           | HCPCS Code | Description                                                                      |
|-------------------------------------|------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ---                                 | ---        | ---                                                                              |
| Pemetrexed (Sandoz)                 | J9297      | Injection, pemetrexed (sandoz), not therapeutically equivalent to J9305, 10 mg   |
| Pemfexy                             | J9304      | Injection, pemetrexed (pemfexy), 10 mg                                           |
| Alimta                              | J9305      | Injection, pemetrexed, not otherwise specified, 10 mg                            |
| Pemetrexed (Teva)                   | J9314      | Injection, pemetrexed (teva) not therapeutically equivalent to J9305, 10mg       |
| Pemetrexed (Bluepoint)              | J9322      | Injection, pemetrexed (bluepoint) not therapeutically equivalent to J9305, 10 mg |
| Pemetrexed ditromethamine (Hospira) | J9323      | Injection, pemetrexed ditromethamine, 10 mg                                      |
| Pemrydi RTU                         | J9324      | Injection, pemetrexed (pemrydi rtu), 10 mg                                       |

## References

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4. Pemetrexed [package insert]. Accord Healthcare, Inc., Durham, Nc. Available at:<https://www.accordhealthcare.us/wp-content/uploads/2022/11/PI-Pemetrexed-Liq-vials July2022.pdf>
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11. Referenced with permission from the NCcN Clinical Practice Guidelines in Oncology (NccN Guidelines).National Comprehensive Cancer Network, Inc. 2025. All rights reserved. Accessed September 12, 2025.To view the most recent and complete version of the guideline, go online to NccN.org.

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### Disclaimer

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| Date       | Updates                                                                                                                                    |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 11/7/2023  | Updated Step Therapy; Addition of HCPCS; Addition of Universal Criteria; Updated references                                                |
| 12/29/23   | Added J9324                                                                                                                                |
| 5/23/24    | Annual Review. Universal Criteria updated.                                                                                                 |
| 8/5/2024   | Added pemetrexed Apotex 505 (b)(2), Updated Universal Criteria, Disclaimer, approval timeframe per compliance 7.2024                       |
| 9/19/2024  | Policy adopted by GEHA; document updated for universal accessibility..                                                                     |
| 11/10/2024 | Updated GEHA logo                                                                                                                          |
| 11/14/2024 | Addition of new HCPCS effective 1/1/2025 pemetrexed avyxa 505 (b) (2); included Alimta brand as PA exempt under J9305 entry for pemetrexed |
| 1/17/2025  | Updated status of Hospira, Sandoz and Teva to non-preferred; accessibility updates to format                                               |
| 07/01/2025 | Updated HCPCS Description for J9292; Updated ST Criteria related to trial of 505(b)(2) generics                                            |
| 10/1/2025  | Annual Review - removed J9999 - approved by OH P&T                                                                                         |
| 10/23/25   | Corrected status of Hospira to non-preferred to align with the change made 1/17/25.                                                        |